



The Robot Who Wanted to Garden

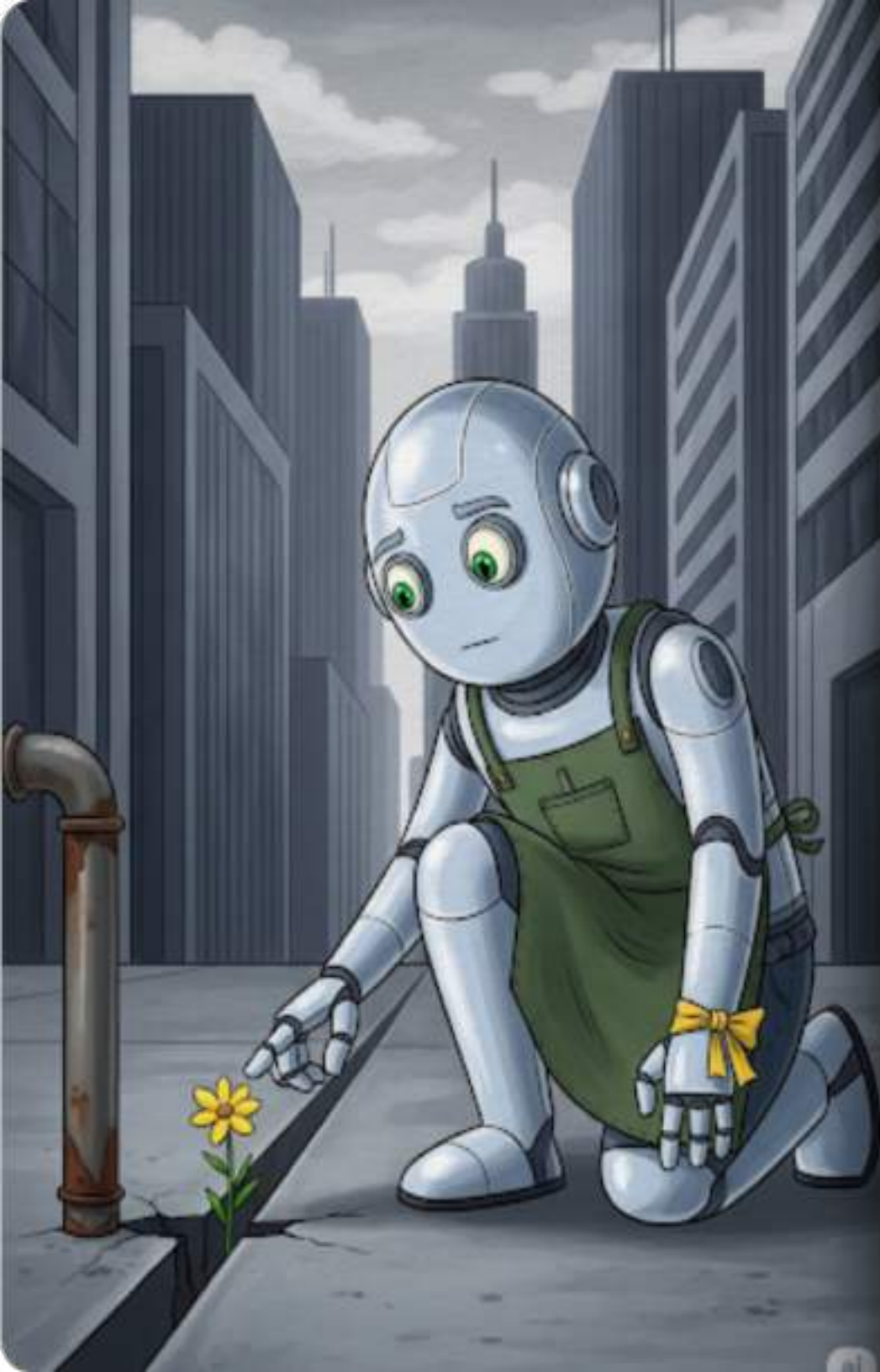
By Einav Momi Ben Shushan and Chen Tzafir



In the heart of the City of Iron, everything was square, silver, and very, very gray. The buildings touched the clouds, and the streets were made of cold, hard concrete. Among the clicking and clanking lived a robot named Bolt. Bolt was different from the other robots; he was round, shiny, and had kind LED eyes that flickered with curiosity.



While the other robots spent their days tightening bolts and polishing gears, Bolt spent his time looking for something else. He didn't know what it was, but he felt a little empty inside his metal chest. He wandered the alleyways, searching for a sign of something soft and bright.



One afternoon, Bolt spotted a tiny flash of color near a rusty pipe. He knelt down and saw a brave, vibrant yellow flower growing out of a small crack in the sidewalk. It was small and delicate, but it was the most beautiful thing Bolt had ever seen. His sensors hummed with excitement.



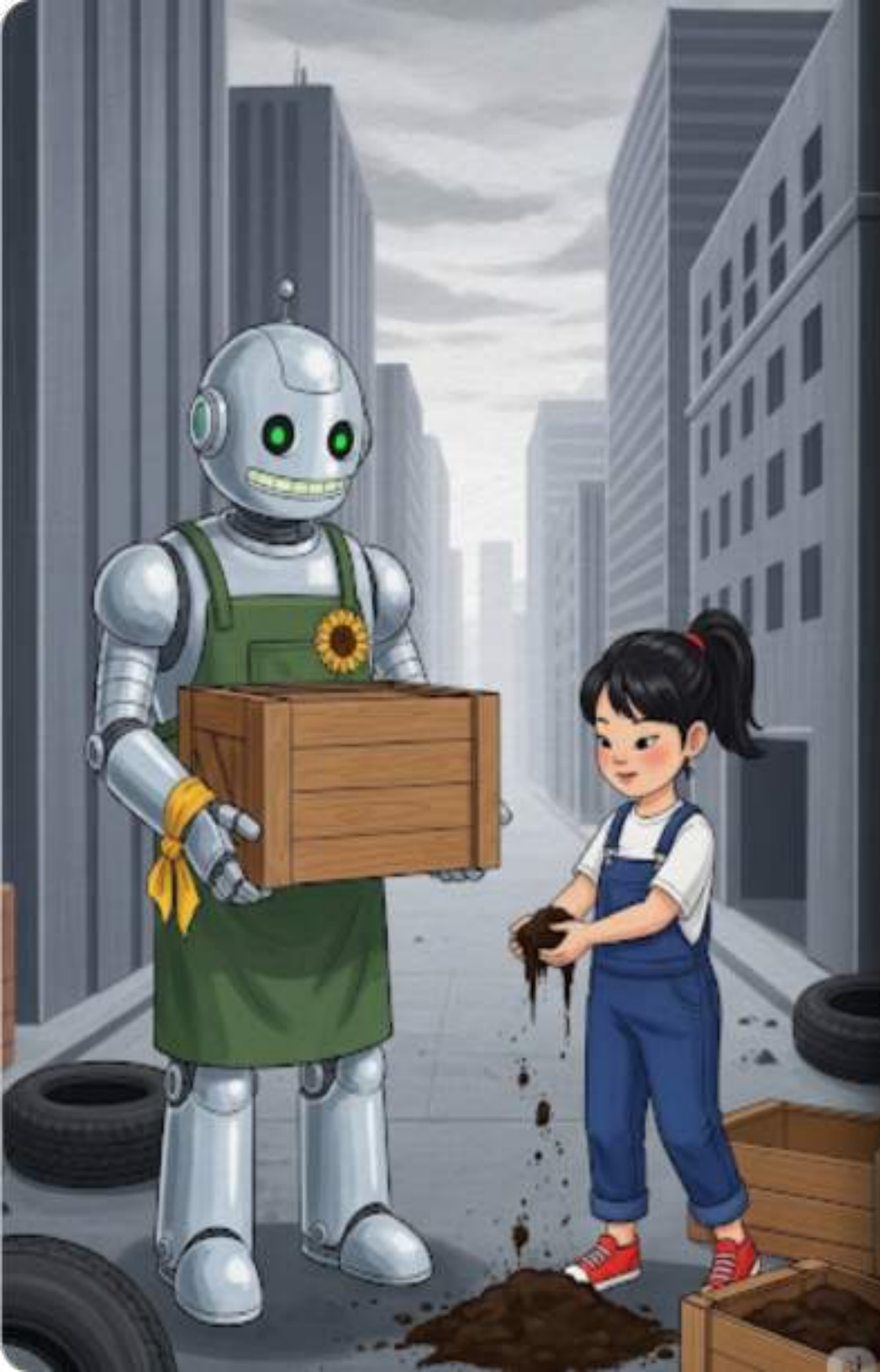
Suddenly, a cold wind whistled through the buildings, shaking the tiny flower. Bolt worried it might break. He stayed right there, using his wide, smooth back to shield the flower from the gusty air. "I will protect you," he hummed softly, his eyes glowing a warm green.



A young girl named Mia was walking by and stopped in surprise. She had never seen a robot sitting so still on the ground. She looked under Bolt's arm and saw the little yellow flower. "Oh! You're taking care of it," she said with a bright smile. "Is it your friend?"



The next morning, Mia returned with a small, red watering can. "Flowers need more than just a shield," she explained to Bolt. "They need water and love to grow big and strong." She carefully tilted the can, letting a sparkling stream of water fall onto the thirsty soil.



Bolt realized that the city needed more than just one flower. He and Mia began to search for more cracks in the concrete. They found old tires and empty crates to use as pots. Together, they tucked tiny seeds into dark, rich earth that Mia brought from the edge of the city.



Days turned into weeks, and Bolt's gray corner began to change. Tiny green shoots peeked out of the crates, and climbing vines started to crawl up the cold metal walls. Bolt spent every morning checking each leaf and bud, his shiny body reflecting the new colors.



Now, the City of Iron isn't so gray anymore. Splashes of red, blue, and yellow can be seen on every street corner. Bolt still lives in the center of it all, no longer a lonely robot. He is the city's head gardener, and his heart is finally full, blooming just like the flowers he loves.